

David Michael Miller was born February 3, 1996, in Richland, WA. He was baptized on April 9, 1996, at Bethlehem Lutheran Church in Kennewick, WA, and confirmed on May 1, 2011, at Trinity Lutheran Church in Saint Peter, MN. He was formerly a member of Richland Lutheran Church in Richland, WA, and presently a member of Our Savior Lutheran in Mankato, MN.

David grew up in the desert, the land of tumbleweeds and sagebrush. He loved family trips to the mountains and the Oregon coast. Observing creatures in the tide pools was a highlight of those trips. Chess was pivotal to David's emerging intellect. He absorbed the game from his brothers and began playing in Kindergarten not having had any instruction. A trophy from a state tournament along with dozens more claimed a shelf in his bookcase. He observed a short time ago that the value of chess in his childhood had not been for the game itself but the training to think about the possibilities three or four steps ahead.

David and his family moved to Saint Peter in 2005. David found a second home in the school theater program, first building sets and then adding sound and lighting technical activities while making good friends in the process. In addition to its value in theater, David's rich, deep voice was an asset in the speech and mock trial programs. He competed in the discussion category where he honed his team-building and conflict-resolution skills, earning a berth at the state tournament. Mock trial rounded out his high school activities. Teammates and opponents alike respected his presence and poise under pressure. His first Red Cross gallon blood donation pin was a point of pride.

David studied biochemistry at the College of Biological Sciences at the University of Minnesota. Pharmacy school was his next goal. He cultivated friendships with roommates and peers that showed his value of scholarship, comradery, humor, and loyalty. Living in an apartment on campus impelled David to learn to cook with his roommates where they prepared and shared nightly meals. From scones to quesadillas, curries and soups to brownies, David and the guys showed creativity and an experimental bent in the kitchen. His mother loved the calls home for advice. David's future showed so much promise.

David lived a short life, but it was a very good life. He filled his time with meaningful work and deep relationships. We will remember his intellect, his curiosity, his wisdom, his wry wit and quirky humor, his kindness, his humility, his faithfulness, his friendship and loyalty, his gift of listening attentively, and his empathy and love.

May this experience of loving and then losing David so soon create in us the desire to listen more patiently and show each other more kindness, more mercy, and more love.

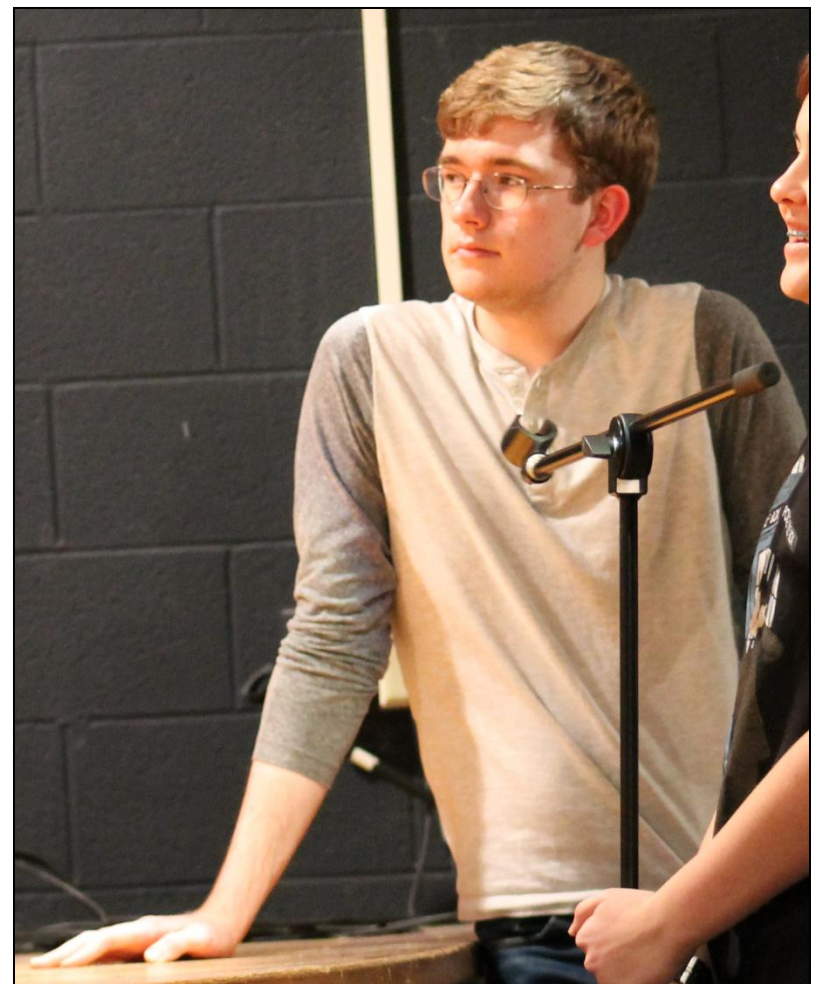
Left to grieve and cherish his memory are his parents, Jim and Laurie; his brothers, Joseph Sander Martinez and Carl; his grandparents, Faye Miller *née* Flohrs and Jack and Carol Ann Sander; his uncles and aunts, Thomas and Cheri Miller, David and Cathryn Miller, Michael Sander, and Douglas Sander; his cousins, Evan Miller (Jennifer Hogan) and Chelsea Miller; and many relatives, friends, and teachers.

David was preceded in death by his grandmother, Betty Mae Sander *née* Wallen; grandfather, George Morris Miller; and his great-grandmother, Helen Agnes Wallen *née* Mickelson.

Memorial suggestion: scholarship fund through Scholarship America, a 501(c)(3) organization: St. Peter-Kasota Dollars for Scholars/David Michael Miller Memorial Fund, PO Box 233, St. Peter, MN 56082 or stpeter-kasota.dollarsforscholars.org Please indicate the donation is in David's memory.

We wish to express our gratitude to the many who have been so kind during these difficult weeks and to all who have contributed to give this day meaning and beauty. Matthew 5:4 "Blessed are those who mourn, for they will be comforted."

Following the service, all are invited to a reception in the Jackson Campus Center.



Memorial Service for David Michael Miller

Gustavus Adolphus College
Christ Chapel
June 3, 2016

David Michael Miller

February 3, 1996 — May 18, 2016

Order of Service

Prelude

Welcome

Invocation

Thanksgiving for Baptism

Processional Hymn

My Faith Looks Up to Thee

Opening Prayer

Tributes

Joseph Sander Martinez

Christian Braunger

Allison Krehbiel

Eric Natwick

Hymn

Be Still, My Soul

Psalms 130

Readings

Matthew 18: 10-14

John 10: 27-28

Romans 5: 1-5

Sermon

Richard Stadler

Galatians 3: 27

Revelation 2: 10

Hymn

Just As I Am, without One Plea

Closing Prayer

Lord's Prayer (Sung)

Commendation

Blessing

Sending Hymn

Blest Be the Tie That Binds

Postlude

Participants

Officiant- Grady St. Dennis

Ministers-

Eric Natwick, Tracy Lutheran Church, Tracy, MN

Richard Stadler, Saint James Lutheran Church, West St. Paul, MN

Reader- Chelsea Miller

Organist- Chad Winterfeldt

Musicians- Michael Jorgenson, Adrian Lo

Psalm 130 De Profundis 664
Source unknown

1 Out of the depths have I cried unto Thee, O Lord. Lord, hear my voice:
3 If Thou, Lord, shouldest mark iniquities, O Lord, who shall stand?
5 I wait for the Lord, my soul doth wait, and in His Word do I hope.
7 Let Israel hope in the Lord; and with Him is plenteous redemption.
9 Glory be to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Ghost;

2 Let Thine ears be attentive to the voice of my supplications.
4 But there is forgiveness with Thee that Thou mayest be feared.
6 My soul waiteth for the Lord more than they that watch for the morning: I say, more than they that watch for the morning.
8 And He shall redeem Israel from all his iniquities.
10 As it was in the beginning, shall be, world without end. Amen.